

Distribution Expansion Framework

A structured framework for entering new territories and channels without creating conflict with your existing sales network.

1. Territory & Channel Assessment

Map candidate territories or channels against three filters: demand signal (is there evidence of unmet demand?), reachability (can you realistically service it — logistics, support, compliance?), and strategic fit (does it reinforce or dilute your core positioning?). Score each candidate rather than choosing on gut feel.

2. Channel Fit Analysis

Decide the right channel structure for each territory — direct sales, distributor/reseller, or hybrid. This should be driven by deal size, sales complexity, and your capacity to support the channel, not by whichever option is easiest to start.

3. Partner Selection Criteria

If using distributors or resellers, define non-negotiable selection criteria upfront: existing customer relationships in the territory, financial stability, cultural fit, and a track record with products of similar complexity. Weak partner selection is the single biggest cause of failed expansion.

4. Conflict Rules (Set Before Launch)

Write down — before any conflict happens — how you'll handle overlapping territories, house accounts, pricing consistency across channels, and lead routing. Ambiguity here is what damages existing relationships, not expansion itself.

5. Rollout Sequencing

Expand in a deliberate sequence: pilot in one territory or channel first, instrument it properly, fix what breaks, and only then replicate. Parallel launches across multiple new territories multiply the same mistake before you've caught it once.

6. Performance Review Cadence

Set a review cadence (monthly for the first two quarters, then quarterly) against a small set of leading indicators — pipeline created, partner activation, conflict incidents — not just revenue, which lags too far behind to let you course-correct in time.

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